Lesson 13

GOD: The Nature and Names of God

Aim: To share the Biblical concept of God.

Introduction:

Because of our finite mind, we cannot fully understand who God is. However, God Himself has made a way that we could understand part of Him, through the Bible. Our series of Study on God will try to lead us into some Biblical understanding of God.

I. THE NATURE OF GOD.

God is a Spirit. John 4:24

24 God is spirit, and his worshippers must worship in spirit and in truth."

A spirit is without flesh and bone. Luke 24:39 “Behold my hands and my feet, that it is I myself: handle me, and see; for a spirit hath not flesh and bones, as ye see me have.”

God has a Personality – (the state of being a person)

A. Basic characteristics of personality are:

Will - Romans 12:2

2 And be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind, that ye may prove what is that good, and acceptable, and perfect, will of God.

Intellect - Prov.3:19-20 "*19 By wisdom, the Lord laid the earth's foundations, by understanding he set the heavens in place; 20 by his knowledge the deeps were divided, and the clouds let drop the dew."*

Emotions - Psalm 111:4 "*4 He has caused his wonders to be remembered; the Lord is gracious and compassionate."*

II. GOD'S NATURE IS ALSO REVEALED THROUGH HIS NAMES

Elohim - *(God)* used when the creative or omnipotent power of God Is described. *Elohim is the creator.*

Jehovah - *(Lord)* This is the Covenant name of God. He revealed His name to Israel as a response to their need for help and salvation.

- *It is the personal NAME of God* in His relationship as Redeemer. (Exodus 3:13-15)

Jehovah - Rapha - "the God that Heals "

Exo. 15:26 "*26 He said, "If you listen carefully to the voice of the Lord your God and do what is right in his eyes, if you pay attention to his commands and keep all his decrees, I will not bring on you any of the diseases I brought on the Egyptians, for I am the Lord, who heals you."*

Jehovah - Nissi - " The Lord our Banner" Exo.17:8-15

15 Moses built an altar and called it The Lord is my Banner.

Jehovah Shalom - " The Lord our Peace" Judges 6:24

24 So Gideon built an altar to the Lord there and called it The Lord is Peace.

To this day it stands in Ophrah of the Abiezrites.

Jehovah Ra'ah - The Lord our shepherd " Psalm 23:1

1 The Lord is my shepherd, I shall not be in want.

Jehovah Tsidkenu - " the Lord our Righteousness"

Jeremiah 23:6

6 In his days, Judah will be saved and Israel will live in safety. This is the name by which he will be called: The Lord Our Righteousness.

Jehovah Shammah - " The Lord is there" Ezekiel 48:35

35 It was round about eighteen thousand measures: and the name of the city from that day shall be, The LORD is there.

Jehovah Jireh - The Lord will provide ..." Genesis 22:14

14 *So Abraham called that place The LORD Will Provide. And to this day it is said, "On the mountain of the LORD it will be provided."*

El - Shaddai - The Almighty God Gen.17:1

1 And when Abram was ninety years old and nine, the Lord appeared to Abram, and said unto him, I am the Almighty God*; walk before me, and be thou perfect.*

El ("God") - used in combination

El - *Elyon means most high God* - Genesis 14:18-29 El - *Olan means "The everlasting God"* Gen. 21:33

Adonai - means Lord or Master- Isaiah 10:16,33

Father - Matthew 6:9, Acts 17:28

CONCLUSION

The God whom we are serving is beyond comprehension in His greatness. It is our privilege to serve Him